

Sarisht Wadhwa

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Summary

My research develops secure and incentive-compatible mechanisms for decentralized systems, with a particular focus on censorship resistance, transaction ordering, and fair transaction fee mechanism design on blockchains. I study how cryptographic tools and algorithmic game theory can be combined to address real-world challenges in decentralized finance and distributed protocol design. I have had the privilege to work with wonderful collaborators from Ethereum Research, Flashbots, Category Labs and Common Prefix.

Education

Ph.D. Major: Computer Science

Thesis: *Security of Blockchains with Rational Entities*
Duke University, North Carolina

Aug 2021 - May 2026

Dual B.Tech./M.Tech. Major: Computer Science

Indian Institute of Technology (IIT), Delhi

July 2014 - June 2019

Publications

* represents equal contribution, $\alpha\beta$ represents alphabetical order

1. **Wadhwa, S.***, Yaish, A.*, Zhang, F., Nayak, K. (2026). *Perils of Parallelism: Transaction Fee Mechanism with Uncertain Execution*. e-print online, To appear in the proceedings of the 35th USENIX Security Symposium, 2026
2. Elsheimy, F.*, Kaklamani, I.*, **Wadhwa, S.***, Papamanthou, C., Zhang, F. (2026). *Censorship Resistance vs Throughput in Multi-Proposer BFT Protocols*. e-print online, To appear in proceedings of the 2026 ACM SIGSAC Conference on Computer and Communications Security (CCS).
3. $\alpha\beta$ Alpos, O., Heimbach, L., Nayak, K., **Wadhwa, S.** (2025). *Censorship-Resistant Sealed-Bid Auctions on Blockchains*. e-print online.
4. Passerat-Palmbach, J. and **Wadhwa, S.** (2025). *Differentially Private aggregate hints in mev-share*. arXiv preprint online.
5. **Wadhwa, S.**, Ma, J., Thierry, T., Mannot, B., Zanolini L., Zhang, F., and Nayak, K. (2024). *AUCIL: An inclusion list design for rational parties*. e-print online.
6. **Wadhwa, S.**, Zanolini, L., D'Amato F., Asgaonkar, A., Fang, C., Zhang, F., and Nayak, K. (2023). *Data Independent Order Policy Enforcement: Limitations and Solutions*. In Proceedings of the 2024 ACM SIGSAC Conference on Computer and Communications Security (CCS).
7. **Wadhwa, S.***, Stöter, J.*, Zhang, F., Nayak, K. (2022). *He-HTLC: Revisiting Incentives in HTLC*. In proceedings of the 2023 Network and Distributed Systems Symposium (NDSS).
8. **Wadhwa, S.**, Prasad, A., Ranu, S., Bagchi, A., Bedathur, S. *Efficiently answering regular simple path queries on large labeled networks*. In Proceedings of the 2019 International Conference on Management of Data (SIGMOD).

Grants and Awards

- **IC3 Summer Camp 2025:** Won the first prize among eight projects. Project: Proposed an elastic restaking design that achieves application dependent security and computed how stake should be divided amongst all such applications.
- **Ethereum Research Grant 2024:** Received a grant to work on improving censorship resistance of Ethereum.
- **Samsung Research Excellence 2021:** Won Samsung's research excellence award in 2021 for research in camera systems.
- **Microsoft Travel Scholarship 2019:** Funded by Microsoft Research to attend the 2019 ACM SIGMOD Conference in Amsterdam, Netherlands.

Service

- **Program Committee:**
 - ACM CCS 2026
 - ACM EC 2026
 - CAAW 2026 (Co located with FC 2026)
 - Agentic Markets Workshop at ICML 2024
 - DEFI Workshop 2024 (Co-located with ACM CCS 2024)
- **External Reviewer:**
 - IEEE SP 2024, 2025, 2026
 - FC 2025, 2026
 - AFT 2022, 2026

Talks

- *Perils of Parallelism*
 - IC3 Summer Camp (June 2026)
 - Designing DeFi (D^2) (May 2026)
 - Yale Applied Cryptography Lab (April 2026)
 - Columbia Crypto-economics Workshop (CCE) (December 2025)
- *AUCIL: An Inclusion List Design for Rational Parties*
 - Yale Applied Cryptography Lab (October 2025)
 - MEV Workshop at Science of Blockchain Conference (July 2025)
- *Data Independent Order Policy Enforcement*
 - University of Michigan Visit (April 2026)
 - ACM Conference on Computer and Communications Security (CCS) (October 2024)
 - DeFi Workshop at ACM Conference on Economics and Computation (July 2024)
 - Yale Security Group (July 2024)
 - Duke Patent Office Visit Day (June 2024)
- *He-HTLC: Revisiting Incentives in HTLC*
 - Network and Distributed System Security Symposium (February 2023)
 - Science of Blockchain Conference (SBC) (August 2022)
 - Crypto Economics Security Conference (October 2022)

Blog Posts

- *Block Building is Not Just Knapsack (Eth Research).*
- *AUCIL: An Auction-Based Inclusion List Design for Enhanced Censorship Resistance on Ethereum (Eth Research).*